

Performance Max Partner Workshop August 18

FAQ

Consolidated questions, answers, guidance, and follow-ups from the Partner Workshop

Purpose

This document consolidates the live attendee questions and broader FAQ guidance covered during the workshop. Validated answers are organized by topic, with the remaining open regulatory question clearly identified.

1. Attendee Questions and Answers

How are Ads in Copilot reported, and can I see whether my ad appeared there?

Today, Ads in Copilot are included within standard Microsoft Advertising reporting and are not reported as a standalone placement or inventory source. For campaign performance, use Microsoft Advertising reporting. For understanding post-click engagement and AI-driven discovery opportunities, [Microsoft Clarity](#) provides the deepest insight through behavioral analytics and AI discovery reporting.

Are Ads in Copilot available in Italy?

Microsoft Copilot is available in Italy. Advertisers using Microsoft Advertising may be eligible to appear in Copilot experiences as Microsoft continues to expand Ads in Copilot. Specific ad availability depends on market support, campaign eligibility, and product rollout status.

Is full search-term reporting available for Performance Max campaigns?

We've had search terms available via search term insights for a while, though it wasn't always easily discoverable for advertisers. As of this month, though, now all advertisers should have search terms in the typical "search term" report like other campaigns.

How can advertisers maximize visibility in Copilot experiences?

Answer: Performance Max was positioned as the primary campaign type for maximizing relevant exposure across Microsoft inventory, including Copilot experiences.

Will Performance Max increase CPCs by competing with existing campaigns?

Answer: No. Exact-match Search campaigns are prioritized over Performance Max. In other cases, the ad with the highest ad rank enters the auction, without a stated CPC impact from self-competition.

Should advertisers use Performance Max instead of Search and Audience Ads?

Answer: No. Search captures high-intent demand, Audience Ads build awareness and demand, and Performance Max expands reach and automation across Microsoft inventory.

What is the minimum data recommendation for Performance Max?

Answer: The session recommended at least 30 conversions in 30 days and avoiding major changes during the learning period.

What are the biggest setup mistakes advertisers make?

Answer: Fragmented structures, incomplete feeds, weak audience signals, inaccurate or missing UET implementation, insufficient conversion volume, and frequent changes during learning.

Which Microsoft-specific capabilities should advertisers prioritize?

Answer: Copilot inventory, multimedia ads, LinkedIn profile audience signals, impression-based remarketing, Microsoft Clarity, UCP support, and brand-related AI tools.

2. General Performance Max and Copilot FAQ

What is Performance Max?

Answer: Performance Max is a cross-channel campaign type that uses AI to optimize advertising across Microsoft inventory based on advertiser-provided goals, assets, landing pages, audience signals, and measurement inputs.

How is Performance Max different from AI Max?

Answer: Performance Max is a separate cross-channel campaign type for broad reach and automation. AI Max enhances existing Search campaigns while retaining more of the Search structure and controls.

Do Performance Max campaigns cannibalize Search?

Answer: The campaign types are complementary. Exact-match Search is prioritized over Performance Max; in other eligible cases, ad rank determines which ad serves.

Will Performance Max automatically appear on Copilot?

Answer: No separate Copilot-specific configuration was identified. Eligible ads may appear when relevant as part of Microsoft Advertising optimization.

Are Ads in Copilot available in Italy?

Answer: Microsoft Copilot is available in Italy. Advertisers using Microsoft Advertising may be eligible to appear in Copilot experiences as Microsoft continues to expand Ads in Copilot. Specific ad availability depends on market support, campaign eligibility, and product rollout status.

3. Campaign Structure and Setup

How many Performance Max campaigns should I run?

Answer: Consolidate whenever practical so the system has enough data to learn. Multiple campaigns should reflect deliberate business requirements.

When should I separate Performance Max campaigns?

Answer: Separate campaigns may be appropriate for different countries or languages, budgets or ROAS targets, product priorities, seasonal moments, shop locations, or brand versus non-brand strategies.

Can I import Performance Max campaigns from Google Ads?

Answer: Most settings can be imported, but Microsoft-specific items require attention, including multimedia ads and LinkedIn profile signals. Review imported bids, budgets, search themes, and negative keyword settings.

How long should the learning period run?

Answer: Aim for at least 30 conversions in 30 days, allow campaigns time to stabilize, and prefer smaller adjustments over large changes.

What budget and bidding guidance was provided?

Answer: Start with accurate conversion tracking and stable inputs, provide enough budget to reach conversion volume, and consider seasonality adjustments for defined peak periods.

4. Feeds, Merchant Center, and AI Readiness

Should I upload my entire product catalog?

Answer: Yes. Upload 100% of the catalog so AI systems can better discover, understand, and match products to relevant users.

What is UCP?

Answer: Universal Commerce Protocol helps AI assistants, platforms, and online stores work together for shopping experiences. Include relevant return policy, support, and product-feed information.

What are the most important feed optimization practices?

Answer: Use robust titles, detailed descriptions, accurate pricing and availability, complete identifiers, accessible high-quality images, working URLs, no duplicate titles, and complete recommended fields.

5. Audience Signals and Creative

Are audience signals hard targeting restrictions?

Answer: No. They guide AI and provide a head start during learning rather than acting as hard targeting limits.

Which audience signals were recommended?

Answer: Customer Match, remarketing, dynamic remarketing, in-market and similar audiences, LinkedIn profile signals, search themes, and impression-based remarketing.

What is LinkedIn profile targeting in Performance Max?

Answer: A Microsoft-specific signal using professional attributes such as company, industry, job function, and, where available, job seniority.

What is impression-based remarketing?

Answer: It enables audience creation from people exposed to an ad even if they did not select it.

How should creative assets be managed?

Answer: Provide varied, relevant assets, preview combinations, refresh creative to avoid fatigue, and use available brand and placement controls.

6. Tracking, Measurement, and Reporting

Why is UET important?

Answer: Universal Event Tracking supports conversion measurement, automated bidding, audience creation, remarketing, Performance Max optimization, and Microsoft Clarity.

Can I use another measurement platform instead of UET?

Answer: Third-party measurement can support reporting, but UET remains important for Microsoft Advertising audience building and optimization capabilities.

How does Microsoft Clarity support Performance Max?

Answer: Clarity provides behavioral analytics, post-click engagement insights, AI crawler activity, AI discovery reporting, rage-click and drop-off signals, and content optimization opportunities.

How are Ads in Copilot reported, and can I see whether my ad appeared there?

Answer: Today, Ads in Copilot are included within standard Microsoft Advertising reporting and are not reported as a standalone placement or inventory source. For campaign performance, use Microsoft Advertising reporting. For understanding post-click engagement and AI-driven discovery opportunities, Microsoft Clarity provides the deepest insight through behavioral analytics and AI discovery reporting.

Is full search-term reporting available for Performance Max campaigns?

Answer: Search terms have been available through Search Term Insights, although this reporting was not always easy for advertisers to discover. As of August 2026, all advertisers should also have Performance Max search terms available in the standard Search term report, consistent with other campaign types.

What other reporting and control capabilities were highlighted?

Answer: Landing-page reporting, the Website URL report with performance metrics, ad preview capabilities, negative keywords, website exclusions, and additional roadmap capabilities were highlighted.

7. Key Takeaways

- Use Performance Max for broad reach and AI-powered optimization, and AI Max to enhance Search with more control.
- Combine campaign types rather than treating one as a universal replacement.
- Consolidate where possible and work toward at least 30 conversions in 30 days.
- Upload the full catalog and strengthen feed quality, Merchant Center settings, and UCP readiness.
- Use first-party data with Microsoft-specific signals.
- Protect the learning period with accurate UET measurement, stable goals, adequate budget, and limited major changes.

8. Follow-Up Tracker

Actual question	Status	Answer / next step
How are Ads in Copilot reported, and can I see whether my ad appeared there?	Answered	Included within standard Microsoft Advertising reporting; use Clarity for post-click engagement and AI discovery insights.
Are Ads in Copilot available in Italy?	Answered with qualification	Copilot is available in Italy; ad eligibility depends on market support, campaign eligibility, and rollout status.

Is full search-term reporting available for Performance Max campaigns?	Answered	Available through Search Term Insights and, as of August 2026, the standard Search term report.
Are AI declarations and metadata added to AI-generated assets for EU regulatory compliance?	Open	Validate with product, legal, or compliance before publishing a definitive answer.